

Determinatives as nouns in English

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Abstract

I argue that English determinatives, including articles, demonstratives, and quantifiers, belong within Noun alongside common nouns, proper nouns, and pronouns. Quantificational common nouns provide the closest comparison: they share complement patterns, number transparency, and restricted dependents with parts of the determinative inventory. The strongest adjectival counterweight connects grade, degree modification, and comparative complementation in four quantifiers. Number and referential contrasts supply further nominal connections. Restricted articles belong to the grouping through their integration into the determinative system.

A separate comparison asks how determinative expressions are headed. Ordinary Head unifies bare, partitive, and externally determined uses, but is available whether determinative is within Noun or separate. A matched grammatical fragment gives those alternatives equal credit for shared structure and identifies their common costs in degree modification. A final comparison favours coordinate rank alongside pronoun over nesting within it.

Keywords: determinatives, nouns, lexical categories, noun phrases, English

I THE QUESTION AND THE ALTERNATIVES

What is the categorial relationship among words such as *some*, *me*, *apple*, and *Brett*? I argue that all four are nouns: determinatives form a coordinate subcategory alongside common nouns, proper nouns, and pronouns. I write the superordinate category as Noun and call the fourfold proposal the DETERMINATIVE-NOUN or D-NOUN ANALYSIS.

I adopt the general framework of *The Cambridge grammar of the English language* (CGEL; Huddleston and Pullum 2002). Unlike CGEL, though, I include determinatives within Noun. The claims concern synchronic English lexical categories.¹

I use DETERMINATIVE for the category containing articles, demonstratives, and quantifiers such as *the*, *this*, *some*, *every*, and *many*.² I reserve DETERMINER for the syntactic function within the noun

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¹I treat these categories as language-specific: a categorization supported by another language's grammar doesn't determine the English categorization.

²For a fuller inventory, see the online "[List of determinatives in English](#)" accompanying Huddleston et al. (2022).

phrase characteristically performed by phrases headed by these words. This distinction separates what kind of word *some* is from what syntactic relationships its phrase participates in.

Compare *take some apples* with *take some*. The word *some* remains determinative in both. Before *apples*, its phrase functions as determiner; without *apples*, the whole expression functions as object. The issue is how these uses fit the lexical taxonomy and the structure of the noun phrase.

Two decisions need separating. The first is whether determinatives belong within Noun. The second is whether expressions such as independent *some* have an ordinary HEAD, the element around which a phrase is built. The D-noun analysis licenses that headedness through Noun membership. A grammar retaining a separate determinative category (D) can license it too. Table 1 identifies the three accounts compared here.

Table 1: The three accounts compared. All retain one determinative category across dependent and independent uses and keep *apples* as Head in *some apples*.

Account	Place of determinative	Independent <i>some</i>
D-noun, ordinary Head	A subcategory of Noun	Ordinary Head, inherited from Noun
Separate D, ordinary Head	A primary category alongside Noun	Ordinary Head, licensed for both Noun and D
Separate D, fusion	A primary category alongside Noun	Joint determiner and Head functions

In *CGEL*, independent *some* jointly realizes determiner and Head through a FUSION OF FUNCTIONS (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 410–412). Ordinary headedness assigns it Head alone. Both accounts give the whole independent expression noun-phrase (NP) status. The choice concerns its internal structure; assigning NP status doesn't by itself decide the lexical category of its head.

Lexical categories and syntactic functions cut across one another. An NP can function as determiner, as in *Kim's book*, and a determinative-headed phrase can function as modifier, as in *the many people* (Payne et al., 2010; Pullum & Miller, 2022).

The DP hypothesis of Abney (1987) concerns a different Head relation. Under that hypothesis, D heads expressions such as *some apples*. I retain noun-headed NPs and reject the DP analysis for English, following the arguments of Pullum and Miller (2022) and Bruening (2020).

Here DP means DETERMINATIVE PHRASE, as in *CGEL*. This differs from the DP-hypothesis usage just described.

Category membership doesn't remove lexical restrictions. *Every apple* is grammatical, but **I'll take every* isn't an ordinary way to accept apples. The rules in §5.2 retain that restriction.

Ordinary Head also has costs. Treating determinatives used as degree modifiers as NP heads broadens the permitted range of NP modifiers in adjective phrases (AdjPs). That commitment affects both ordinary-Head accounts (§5.3). Their shared structural gains and costs leave the category decision to the broader grammatical comparison.

CGEL already includes pronouns within Noun on the basis of their phrases' functions, despite differences from common and proper nouns in inflection and dependents (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 327–328). The inclusion of auxiliaries within Verb supplies a further precedent for pre-

serving distinctive properties within a broader lexical category (Pullum & Wilson, 1977). These precedents motivate comparing the whole grammatical profile, rather than requiring every member to display each nominal property.

The comparison weighs three considerations: how broadly a property occurs, how it recurs across constructions, and how specifically it connects the groups. These considerations apply equally to nominal and adjectival connections. A pattern concentrated in a few words can be substantial evidence; its contribution depends on its grammatical relationships as well as its reach.

Earlier accounts connect articles with pronouns or give both nominal structure, at different analytical levels (Appendix A). Hudson's nested noun taxonomy is considered in §6; Spinillo's redistribution of determinatives in §3.

Section 2 compares the grammatical profiles, and §3 completes the case for the intended inventory. Section 4 then compares internal structures, which the fragment in §5 makes explicit and assesses. The further question of coordinate or nested rank follows in §6.

2 GROUNDS FOR A BROADER NOUN CATEGORY

The existing Noun category contains common nouns, proper nouns, and pronouns with markedly different meanings, inflection, and dependents. Ordinary count nouns alone are an inadequate comparison group. The question is how determinatives connect with that broader range, and how those connections compare with their affinities to adjectives.

2.1 FUNCTIONS AND CONSTRUCTIONAL RANGE

The external syntax of a phrase concerns the functions it fills in larger constructions. Noun phrases can serve as subjects, objects, and complements of prepositions. Determinatives enter these constructions too, with the lexical restrictions illustrated below.

Independent use is widespread within the determinative inventory. *CGEL* discusses such uses for demonstratives and quantifiers including *some*, *all*, *both*, *many*, *few*, *several*, *each*, *either*, *neither*, *much*, and *enough*, while recording lexical restrictions and the separate forms *no/none* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 371–372, 410–424). The generalization concerns the availability of independent constructions across a lexical category, not unrestricted acceptability in every sentence frame.³

In the constructed examples in (1), compare the bracketed NPs as subjects, objects, and complements of prepositions. Assume that a woman named Kim and a group of people are already under discussion. The comparison concerns the phrases' functions; §4 considers their internal structure.

³Material before a determiner falls outside the independent-use comparison. *CGEL* treats *all/both* in *all/both the books* as predeterminer modifiers, *quite/rather* before *a good idea* as peripheral modifiers, and *such/exclamative what* before *a disaster* as adjectives (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 433–437). The fixed *many a* is a complex determinative restricted to Det function (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 394). The *half* in *half a cake* is a common noun used as a predeterminer modifier (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 434). These constructions don't add evidence for independent determinative heads.

- (1) a. [*People*] left. I see [*people*]. with [*people*]
 b. [*Kim*] left. I see [*Kim*]. with [*Kim*]
 c. [*She*] left. I see [*her*]. with [*her*]
 d. [*Some*] left. I see [*some*]. with [*some*]

Independent uses containing fused-head AdjPs prevent a simple inference from these positions to nounhood. *The rich* and *the poor* can fill nominal argument positions. Comparative and superlative adjectives also head expressions without a generic human interpretation: CGEL's *the most important of her criticisms* is an NP containing a partitive *of*-phrase (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 332–333, 416–423).

Independent *some* can form a one-word NP, whereas an NP with *rich* as fused head requires the definite article *the* on the generic human reading (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 417–418). That is a local contrast: argument NPs headed by singular count common nouns also need determination. The broader comparison has to include dependents, inflection, and interpretation as well as external position.

Determiner function also cuts across the existing noun subcategories. In *my preferences*, *Kim's preferences*, and *people's preferences*, the determiner is an NP ultimately headed by a pronoun, a proper noun, and a common noun respectively (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 354–355, 470–471).⁴

The compound determinative *someone*, following the categorization of Payne et al. (2007, §1.3), participates in *someone's preferences*. Plain-case NPs also fill Det: *what size* in *what size shoes*, *that size* in *that size shoes*, and *Sunday* in *Sunday morning* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 356).

Determiner remains the characteristic function of determinative phrases. This specialization could support a separate primary category. Its tasks are themselves closely connected with nominal reference: Det marks definiteness and often contributes quantification (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 354–359). The issue is whether that specialization warrants a primary boundary or a distinction within Noun.

The existing NP determiners provide a positive comparison. In *Kim's preferences*, the embedded NP supplies an identifying anchor through its own referent; *Sunday* and *what size* specify a day or a dimension. Determinatives' deictic and quantitative specifications fit this nominal pattern. I take that fit to support treating their specialization in Det as a distinction within Noun.

Preposition phrases (PPs) remain a restricted alternative, as in *up to twenty minutes* and *between fifty and sixty tanks* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 356). Number, countability, and other selectional conditions distinguish the determining expressions.

Modifier and adjunct functions also cut across the groups. Compare the modifiers in *dog houses*, *Canada Day*, *the manager herself*, and *the few people*. Emphatic *herself* also functions as a clause adjunct in *The manager detected the error herself* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 1496–1497). Temporal NPs such as *that day* and *Sunday* supply adjuncts, as does degree *enough* in *I hadn't prepared enough* (§5.3). These are shared functions with construction-specific distributions.

Relative-clause postmodification supplies a further constructional comparison. Common nouns freely take integrated relatives, as in *people who came*; personal pronouns permit a restricted range, including *we who have read the report* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 430). Determinative examples

⁴CGEL assigns these genitives the combined function Subject–Det (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 472–473). I treat them as Det here, without the additional subject function.

include *few who come ever leave*, *those who came*, *that which remains*, and *something that you need to know*.

Compounds also permit *anyone who asks* and *everything that matters*. With books under discussion, compare *some that I saw* and *two that I have seen*. *CGEL* describes relative postmodification with demonstratives and compounds (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 414, 422–423).

Compound determinatives also take post-head adjectives. *CGELBank*, a treebank annotated in the *CGEL* framework (Reynolds et al., 2023), attests *I need something reliable and good looking*.⁵ The position and interpretation of these modifiers have specialized conditions (§4.5).

2.2 THE CONNECTION FROM QUANTIFICATIONAL COMMON NOUNS

Quantificational common nouns make the connection more specific than shared quantity meanings. In *a lot of the delegates* and *many of the delegates*, both heads quantify over a partitive DOMAIN: the whole from which a quantity is drawn, here the delegates. But *lot* also permits *a lot of delegates*, whereas **many of delegates* is excluded (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 349). The comparison links the groups through a shared construction while preserving a specific difference in complementation.

Agreement provides another connection. Compare the constructed *A lot of the people were waiting* and *Some of the people were waiting*, with plural agreement, against *A lot of the work was finished* and *Some of the work was finished*, with singular agreement. The whole subject NP's number depends on the complement of *of*. *CGEL* calls quantificational *lot* NUMBER-TRANSPARENT (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 349–350, 411–412).

This pattern connects particular constructions, not every member of either category. Singular *each of the people* doesn't take its number from *people*; nor does ordinary *a photograph of the people*. Number transparency strengthens the comparison between quantificational *lot* and number-neutral *some* without turning complement number into a general rule for Noun.

Restricted dependents also occur on the common-noun side. *CGEL* categorizes quantificational *plenty* as a common noun whose use resists determination and modification; *lot* requires *a* and permits only limited modification (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 349–350). Established common nouns thus approach the determinative profile as determinatives approach theirs. Ordinary count nouns alone provide an inadequate comparison group.

The connection also extends beyond argument NPs. Quantificational nouns occur in degree modifiers such as *a great deal smaller* and *plenty big enough* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 549–550). Section 5.3 compares these with determinative degree modifiers, including the restrictions on their attributive use. Meaning, complementation, agreement, and restricted dependents give the proposed grouping a specific basis within established Noun.

The comparison is specific to these constructions. Common nouns also permit a wider range of PP and clausal complements, whereas pronouns and primary naming uses of proper nouns have much more restricted dependents (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 429–430, 439–443, 517–521). Partitives such as *a lot/some of the wine* connect established common nouns with determinatives without making their complement systems identical.

2.3 THE CONNECTED ADJECTIVAL PROFILE

The strongest adjectival connection also concerns a restricted group: *few*, *many*, *much*, and *little*. They distinguish plain, comparative, and superlative forms: *few/fewer/fewest*, *many/more/most*, and

⁵Sentence `answers-20111024111513AAAQhAO_ans-0003` in `ewt-test_iaa50.cgel`.

corresponding paradigms for *little* and *much* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 391–395). Grade combines with degree-modifier selection and comparative complementation, as in *more than ten*. The three properties form a connected profile.

Degree *very* selects gradable heads: *very tall* and *very few*, but **very you*, **very the book*, and **very my life*. It also excludes non-gradable determinatives: **very every*, **very some*, and **very this*. The associated series includes *so few*, *too few*, *how few*, and *as few as*. These degree patterns select *few*, *many*, *much*, and *little*, the four determinatives that inflect for grade (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 393–395, 431–432).⁶

With the complex determinative *a few*, modifier position distinguishes two kinds of attachment. *CGEL* explicitly contrasts internal *very* in *a very few mistakes* with peripheral *quite* in *quite a few mistakes* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 392, (61)). The reversed orders **very a few* and **a quite few* are excluded in these constructions. Here *a* belongs to the complex determinative; *very* occurs within it and *quite* outside it.

Approximative and focusing modifiers have a broader distribution. Compare *almost every*, *nearly all*, *hardly any*, *practically no*, *almost everyone*, and *almost ten*. They have counterparts in established NP modification: *almost the whole class*, *hardly a day*, and *only the best*. In *almost every student*, *almost* approximates the quantity; it doesn't intensify a gradable property of *every*.

The broader approximative pattern supplies NP parallels distinct from the four quantifiers' adjectival profile. Section 4.4 develops an attachment analysis of that contrast, available under either ordinary-Head taxonomy.

Even the gradable forms have syntax distinct from adjectives: *so many mistakes* contrasts with **so numerous mistakes* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 392–396, 431–432, 539–540).

CGEL records predicative *Its advantages are several* and *Their enemies were many*, describing the latter pattern as uncommon and formal (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 392, 395–396). This use is available to only part of the determinative inventory; *every* and the articles remain excluded.

Overlap with adjectives likewise needs phrase levels kept distinct. Both *the people* and *the rich* are NPs in *CGEL*, though only the former has a noun as lexical head. In *a soccer/round ball*, a noun-headed expression and an AdjP share modifier function; in *Jones became president/ill*, NP and AdjP share predicative complement function. External functions alone therefore don't establish nounhood.

She is a beauty ascribes a property, whereas *That is Kim* identifies a person. *CGEL* excludes specifying *be* clauses from its noun–adjective diagnostic because phrases from other categories occur in them too (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 536).

Nominal grammar also distinguishes predicative and argument uses. A bare-role NP such as *president* is licensed in *I'd like to be president*, but requires determination in the corresponding object use *I'd like to meet the president* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 328). Determinatives' asymmetries fit this broader variation within Noun.

Bare colour expressions and evaluative comparative subjects complicate a simple distributional boundary. *CGEL's* *Henrietta likes red shirts*, and *I like blue* permits reduction licensed by coordination. The constructed *Blue is good* raises a separate ambiguity between noun and adjective, while

⁶The restriction concerns this degree series. *CGEL* also records modifiers of completeness, including *marginally enough* and *absolutely all*, with different selectional ranges (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 432). Those combinations don't extend the *very/so/too/how* series beyond the four degree determinatives.

the attested *Bluer is better* establishes a bare comparative subject without settling its phrase category.⁷ These cases leave the wider comparison of argument distribution and head properties necessary.

2.4 NUMBER, GENITIVE MARKING, AND REFERENCE

Inflection supplies several connections with established nouns, though no one contrast runs through the whole category. Common nouns typically distinguish singular and plural; proper nouns permit number inflection in restricted uses such as *the Smiths*. Demonstratives likewise distinguish *this/these* and *that/those* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 373, 521). These are contrasts between forms of a lexeme, unlike the fixed number restrictions of *each* and *several*.

Number needn't be inflectional wherever it matters. *CGEL* treats singular and plural *you* as distinct lexemes, differentiated overtly only by the reflexive forms *yourself* and *yourselves* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 486). Number-neutral *some* has no corresponding singular–plural alternation. The demonstratives supply positive morphological evidence; the absence of that alternation elsewhere doesn't distinguish determinatives from pronouns as whole categories.

The demonstrative number contrasts remain visible in independent uses. Generic human *the rich*, by contrast, is a plural NP whose adjective lacks number inflection and still takes adverb modifiers: *the very rich* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 418). The difference concerns overt paradigms, rather than the mere possession of a number value by the whole NP.

Case gives a further partial connection. Genitives occur across the proposed subcategories: *dog's*, *Kim's*, *my*, and *someone's*. Personal pronouns have fuller case paradigms. Most determinatives lack case inflection, and compounds such as *someone* and *something* may owe their genitives to the nominal component (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 423–424, 479–480). This supports the compounds' nominal affinity more directly than the category's membership as a whole.

Meaning and reference vary within Noun. *Apple* describes a category; *Kim*, in its primary naming use, identifies through a name; *she* depends on context. Determinatives range from deictic *this* to quantitative *many* and universal *every* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 358–360, 370–405, 425–428, 515–521). Deixis connects demonstratives with pronouns, while quantity connects determinatives with common nouns such as *number* and *majority*.

These meanings aren't exclusive to nouns. Adjectives such as *singular* and *plural* also concern number; *proximate* and *distal* describe spatial relations relevant to demonstrative contrasts, though spatial meaning needn't itself be deictic. Nor does Noun imply close semantic similarity throughout: *every* quantifies over a nominal restriction, while *Kim* identifies an individual. Semantic affinities contribute to the comparison without settling its boundaries.

Pro-form gender (Reynolds, 2025) connects these ways of referring. Descriptions such as *the woman* and names such as *Kim* identify referents whose construal bears on pro-form choice. Pronouns and determinatives express contrasts between personal *she/somebody* and non-personal *it/something*. Relative *who/which* supplies another contrast.⁸

⁷The *blue*, *old*, and *small* examples on *CGEL* p. 417 all occur in coordinated contrasts. *Bluer is better* accompanies a results colour scale in Stanford CS329X, “Codeswitching LLMs”, slide 8 (accessed 10 September 2026). I interpret it as evaluating a degree of blueness. Subject function alone doesn't establish NP status (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 236).

⁸Whether independent *what* and relative *which* belong to pronoun or determinative leaves them within the proposed Noun category. I leave that internal boundary open here; *CGEL*'s inventory suffices for the present comparison (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 397–399).

Interrogative and relative properties are distinct from functions such as object. An interrogative object may be headed by a pronoun (*who*) or a common noun (*which book*); the latter obtains its interrogative property from a dependent. Neither the object function nor the interrogative construction determines the lexical head's category.

Inflection and reference provide partial connections, with different reach. Demonstrative number directly compares forms of determinative lexemes with nominal number paradigms; compound genitives may depend on their nominal component. The *no/none* alternation concerns form selection, discussed with restricted membership in §3.2. None of these properties is a necessary condition for every member of Noun.⁹

2.5 WEIGHING THE PROFILES

Table 2 summarizes the comparison. Functions concern phrases, while inflection concerns word forms. AdjP and AdvP denote adjective and adverb phrases. The modification rows identify proposed determinative attachments, explained in §4.4. The rows aren't equally weighted tests, and several properties belong to one connected pattern.

⁹Derivations such as *nothingness* and *oneness* are weaker category diagnostics: *-ness* also attaches to adjectives and other bases (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 19, §5.7.2(i)). Numeral morphology likewise needs its inputs distinguished. Reynolds (2026, §§5.4–5.5) derives fractional nouns from cardinal nouns and treats *two thousand and twenty-seventh* as a coordination whose final coordinate is adjectival. Neither process independently establishes determinative nounhood.

Table 2: Profiles compared. Determinative modifier attachments are analytical commitments; interrogative and relative forms follow *CGEL*'s inventory.

Dimension	Common noun	Proper noun	Pronoun	Determinative
Argument / Det functions	NP arguments; genitive Det	NP arguments; genitive Det	NP arguments; genitive Det	NP arguments; plain and genitive Det
Accepts determination	Broad contrasts; singular count arguments normally require it	Restricted in primary naming uses	Normally excluded	Lexically restricted: <i>the few, these three</i>
Internal modification	Productive AdjP and nominal premodifiers; relative postmodifiers	Restricted AdjP premodifiers and embellishments	Restricted AdjP premodifiers and relative postmodifiers	Degree AdvP on four quantifiers; NP modifiers; <i>the lucky few</i> ; relatives
Complemen- tation	Selected PPs and clauses	Not characteristic of primary naming uses	Normally absent	Partitive <i>of</i> -PPs; comparative <i>than</i> -phrases
Peripheral AdvP	<i>only the book</i>	<i>even Kim</i>	<i>only you</i>	<i>almost every</i> ; <i>hardly any</i> ; <i>almost ten</i>
Modifier / adjunct functions	<i>dog houses; that day</i>	<i>Canada Day</i> ; <i>Sunday</i>	Emphatic reflexives in both functions	<i>the few people</i> ; degree adjuncts
Meaning	Descriptive properties and relations	Naming in primary uses	Person, deixis, anaphora, and interrogation	Quantification, definiteness, deixis, and interrogation
Pro-form gender	Descriptions shape referent construal	Names identify referents construed by gender	Gender- sensitive forms	Gender- sensitive forms and constructions
Inflection	Number and genitive	Genitive; restricted number	Case, including genitive; reflexive forms	Number; grade; genitive; <i>no/none</i>
Interrogative / relative constructions	Through another constituent, e.g. <i>which book</i>	Through another constituent	<i>who, whose</i>	<i>which, what</i> , and <i>-ever</i> forms
Inventory	Open	Open to new names	Closed	Closed

Both the nominal and adjectival connections are unevenly distributed. Quantificational common nouns supply a connected comparison involving quantity, complements, agreement, and restricted dependents. The four gradable quantifiers supply a connected adjectival profile. Concentration in a subgroup doesn't make either comparison negligible. Their significance depends on how each pattern connects with the rest of the inventory.

I give greater weight to the recurring nominal profile. Argument and determiner functions, participles, relative postmodification, and number and referential contrasts connect determinatives with established parts of Noun. Within this range, the gradable quantifiers retain their determining and independent uses alongside the degree pattern. Keeping them within determinative expresses those connections while locating the grade and degree restrictions in a narrower group.

The broader Noun grouping still needs an account of restricted members. Their inclusion depends on how they participate in the determinative system.

3 RESTRICTED MEMBERS AND THE SCOPE OF THE GROUPING

The category-level argument draws on constructions that many determinatives enter. Articles lack ordinary independent uses, so their inclusion needs a further argument: they belong to the determinative system whose broader profile supports Noun membership. The *no/none* paradigm raises a related question about restrictions on forms.

3.1 ARTICLES WITHIN THE DETERMINATIVE SYSTEM

Why categorize the articles *the* and *a* as nouns if they can't stand independently? *Every* is restricted too, while *no* has the distinct independent form *none* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 371–372, 410–411).

CGEL's treatment of *my* supplies a precedent for restricted membership within Noun (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 470–471). Dependent *my* and independent *mine* belong to one pronoun paradigm. *My* remains a noun even though, in the ordinary NP construction, it requires a following nominal. For articles, the corresponding positive evidence is integration into determinative; their nounhood depends on the category-level argument.

The articles participate in the determinative system of definiteness, quantity, and count restrictions. In *the/a/this/every book*, they occupy the same Det position and contribute to the interpretation of the NP. *The* permits singular, plural, and non-count targets; *a* selects a singular count target and contributes individuation. Their connections extend beyond shared position, although neither has the full determinative profile (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 368–373).

The also participates in degree modification. In *the bigger the better*, it modifies comparative AdjPs, as other determinatives do in *much bigger* or *no better* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 1131–1132, 1135–1136). This supplies a connection outside ordinary Det function while preserving its exclusion from independent argument use.

A also enters the complex determinatives *a few*, *a little*, and *many a*. In the last, *many* contributes a large number and *a* an individuating, distributive effect. *CGEL* treats *many a* as syntactically fixed: it doesn't establish that ordinary *a* freely accepts modifiers (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 392–394). It does connect the article with quantificational constructions beyond *a book*.

Spinillo (2004, pp. 153–158) instead retains *the*, *a*, and *every* as an expanded article category and redistributes other determinatives among adjectives and pronouns (Spinillo, 2004, pp. 194–195). Her grounds include dependence on a following nominal, lack of predicative and partitive

uses, and limited descriptive content. She also recognizes differences within the article trio. The issue is whether this cluster warrants separating the trio from the wider determinative system.

Every connects with independent *each* through universal quantification and singular count selection. It also permits *almost/nearly* and occurs after genitives in *her every move*. Spinillo (2004, pp. 156–158) recognizes these differences from *the* and *a*, as well as the articles' greater phonological dependence. Her restricted grouping is thus a substantive alternative, not merely an omission of inconvenient properties.

The issue is how much independent support its shared restrictions provide. Absence of bare, predicative, and partitive uses all limits occurrence without a following nominal; they aren't three independent reasons for a primary category. Little descriptive content extends well beyond the trio. Meanwhile, *a*'s quantificational constructions and *every*'s modifier permissions cross the proposed article boundary. I retain the restricted members within determinative because these connections preserve a broader system without granting unrestricted use to any member.

Spinillo (2004, pp. 140–144) draws an analogy with verbs and prepositions whose complements can be omitted. For demonstratives and quantifiers such as *some* and *all*, occurrence before a nominal (*some teachers*) alternates with occurrence without one (*some left*). The analogy supports category continuity, but leaves the category to be established: *CGEL*, Hudson, and the D-noun analysis can all preserve it.

The argument for retaining the articles is synchronic. Grammaticalization supplies background: C. Lyons (1999, pp. 331–336) discusses the development of definite articles from demonstratives and of articles expressing cardinality from numerals. These histories can explain changes in content and use, but don't establish the synchronic categorization.

3.2 DEPENDENT AND INDEPENDENT FORMS

No/none illustrates a restriction on forms within a paradigm. *CGEL* treats them as inflectional forms of one determinative: dependent *no students* contrasts with independent *none*, while both permit *almost* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 389–390). The partitive *none of the students* requires the independent form; **no of the students* is excluded. Form selection remains necessary, just as with *my/mine*.

The broader grouping preserves two distinctions: between members' permitted constructions, and between the forms selected within a paradigm. A successful structural account has to respect both. The following section compares the Head relations once an expression's use is licensed.

4 ORDINARY HEAD, FUSION, AND MODIFIER ATTACHMENT

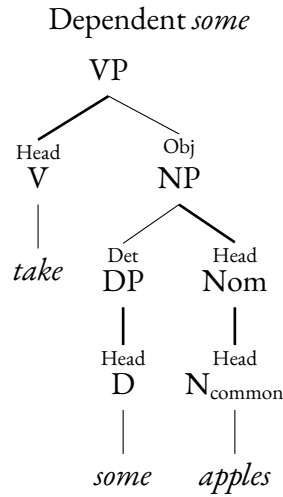
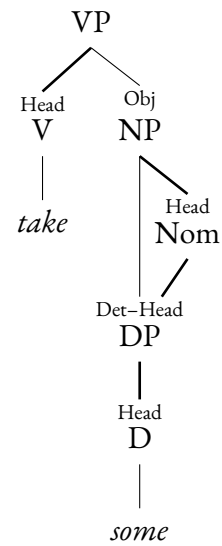
The category comparison and membership argument leave a structural choice. How should a grammar represent independent *some*, *some of the wine*, and *the lucky few*? All are overt expressions with nominal uses. Ordinary headedness gives their determinatives Head; fusion combines Head with a dependent function. Each analysis preserves some generalizations and requires particular restrictions.

4.1 THE BASIC HEAD RELATIONS

A NOMINAL (Nom) contains a head and its internal dependents, excluding an external determiner. In *some apples*, the word *apples* heads Nom, and that Nom heads NP. The same arrangement permits an internal modifier, as in *some red apples*, without making the determining phrase part of the Nom.

Under D-noun, a determinative can head this Nom–NP structure too. Figure 1 compares the accounts for *take some apples* and *take some*. The dependent expression still has *apples* as its ultimate head. Independent *some* has ordinary Head under D-noun; in *CGEL*, its DP jointly fills Det of NP and Head of Nom.

CGEL

Independent *some*

D-noun analysis

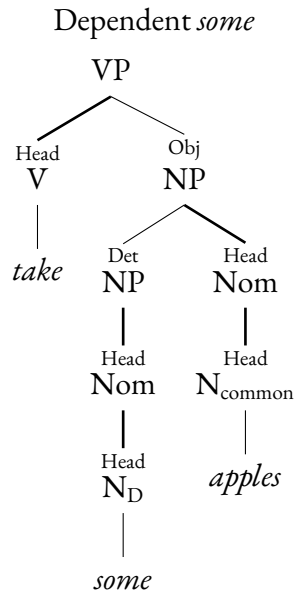
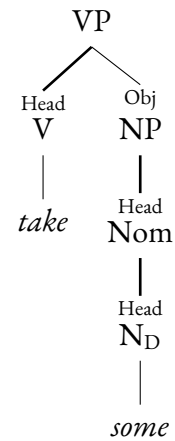
Independent *some*

Figure 1: *Take some apples* (left) and *take some* (right) under *CGEL* (top) and the D-noun analysis (bottom). In the upper-right tree, DP fills Det of NP and Head of Nom. In the lower pair, *some* heads an NP through the same nominal projection; that NP functions as Det on the left and Obj on the right. Function labels appear above category labels. Det marks determiner, Obj object, and Det-Head fusion; the two links show the combined functions. N, D, and V mark noun, determinative, and verb; NP, DP, and VP mark their phrases. Subscripts identify noun subcategories.

Under D-noun, INHERITANCE makes Noun’s projection rules available to determinatives, subject to their restrictions. The separate-D ordinary-Head account can use the same phrase structure by admitting both Noun and D into those rules.

The genitive NP *Kim’s* already fills Det in *Kim’s preferences*, as Figure 2 shows. Ordinary determinative headedness gives *some* that phrase type in Det and object uses alike. Plain determinative-headed NPs, such as *almost ten* in *almost ten apples*, then join genitives such as *Kim’s* and *my*. The fragment compares the remaining selectional conditions (§5.2).

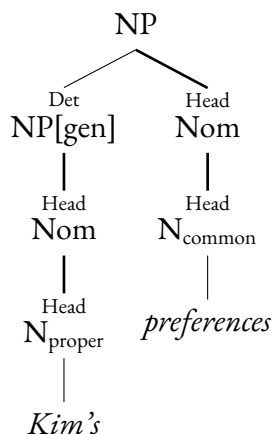


Figure 2: The genitive NP *Kim’s* functions as determiner within *Kim’s preferences*, ultimately headed by *preferences*. The representation abstracts from the internal realization of genitive marking.

4.2 SYNTACTIC COMPLETENESS AND CONTEXTUAL INTERPRETATION

With a group of people under discussion, *Some left*, *Many came*, and *All agree* illustrate STRUCTURAL SATURATION: an argument expression can be syntactically complete without another overt head or determiner. Syntactic completeness differs from contextual interpretation. In *I’ll take some*, the relevant substance or set may be supplied by discourse or the situation. That dependence doesn’t establish a deleted common noun: ordinary pronouns also depend on context.

In the following attestation from the CGELBank treebank, *two different Honda models* supplies the domain for the independent object *both*:¹⁰

- (2) *Went there yesterday: we are trying to decide between two different Honda models, so we wanted to test-drive both back to back.*

Generalizing expressions such as *Many are called*, *few are chosen* and *Enough is enough* need no previously uttered common-noun phrase. They rule out a mandatory overt-antecedent requirement, but a silent-noun account could supply a generic restriction. Generic pronoun *one*, as in *One shouldn’t judge*, provides a parallel without a required overt antecedent. Such examples don’t decide whether the restriction belongs in semantics or syntax.

The comparison with ordinary pronouns and proper nouns is structural as well as interpretive. In *She left* and *Kim left*, CGEL permits an NP headed by a nominal with no determiner. Applying that

¹⁰CGELBank (Reynolds et al., 2023), sentence reviews-083459-0002.

structure to *Some left* preserves the same division between a complete NP and its context-dependent reference. The dependent use of *some* doesn't by itself require a Det function inside every independent occurrence.

Fusion offers another representation of that complete expression. In Payne et al. (2007), one constituent jointly realizes Head and a dependent function, subject to structural and adjacency conditions. Contextual recovery alone doesn't decide between this arrangement and ordinary Head. Both analyses retain an overt determinative and can express the restriction supplied by context.

4.3 PARTITIVES AND EXTERNALLY DETERMINED EXPRESSIONS

In *some of the wine*, *some* specifies a quantity drawn from an identifiable amount of wine. The NP *the wine* denotes the partitive domain and is complement of *of*. A pronoun-headed NP or independent genitive NP can express the domain too: *many of them*, referring to previously mentioned people, or *some of Kim's*, referring to Kim's apples.

Compare where the common noun occurs in *some apples* and *some of the wine*. In the partitive, *wine* is embedded inside the *of*-phrase, so it can't be the lexical head of the whole NP. The comparison instead concerns the head-like role of *some* in that larger expression.

Figure 3 gives the D-noun analysis, with the *of*-phrase functioning as complement within Nom, as in *CGEL's* partitive tree (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 411–412). *CGEL* represents the head-like role of *some* through Det–Head fusion. Partitives support that role while leaving the choice between fusion and ordinary headedness open.

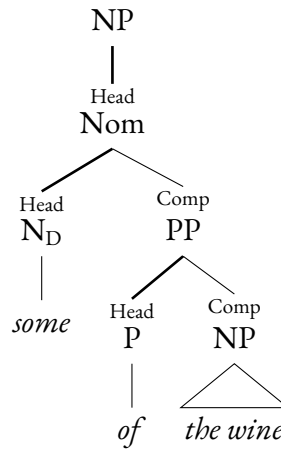


Figure 3: *Some of the wine* under the D-noun analysis. The Head relations lead from the outer NP to *some*. The common noun *wine* is inside the complement PP and doesn't head the whole expression. The inner NP is abbreviated.

The overt quantifier and domain already supply a compositional interpretation of *some of the wine*. A silent common noun would need to explain something further, such as a restriction on interpretation or modification that the overt-head account misses. The construction itself supplies no such requirement. I therefore prefer an overt-head analysis over an otherwise equivalent null-head analysis; fusion remains compatible with that preference.

The pair *the lucky survivors/the lucky few* supplies a comparison involving both an external determiner and an attributive-modifier AdjP. *CGEL* explicitly permits determinatives used as internal modifiers to fuse with Head, as in *the other two* and *these few here* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 415–416). Its analysis of *the few mistakes* assigns *the* to Det and *few* to Mod (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 392). That dependent use supplies the counterpart for a Mod–Head analysis of independent *few* after an external determiner.

Figure 4 compares the resulting analyses of *the lucky few*. Both have an overt Det and a Nom modified by *lucky*. In the D-noun analysis, *few* fills Head. In the fusion analysis, its DP fills Mod–Head. The competing structure thus uses machinery already needed for adjectival fusion; it requires neither a silent noun nor conversion.

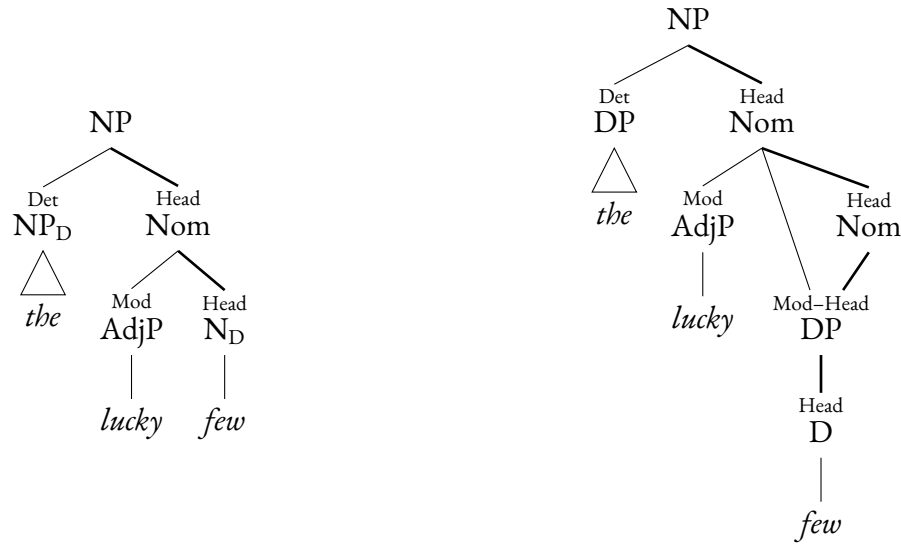


Figure 4: *The lucky few* with ordinary Head (left) and Mod–Head fusion (right). The determiner is separately realized in both. Internal structure within the article phrase and AdjP is suppressed.

Table 3 compares the Head relations across four constructions; §5.2 supplies the rules under both taxonomies.

Table 3: Head and dependent functions under matched analyses. Each independent expression is an NP; *the* fills Det wherever it appears. The ordinary-Head column applies to both taxonomies permitting ordinary determinative heads.

Expression	Separate D with fusion	Ordinary determinative Head
<i>few survivors</i>	<i>few</i> : Det; <i>survivors</i> : Head	Same functions
Independent <i>few</i>	<i>few</i> : Det–Head	<i>few</i> : Head
<i>the lucky few</i>	<i>few</i> : Mod–Head; <i>lucky</i> : Mod	<i>few</i> : Head; <i>lucky</i> : Mod
<i>the idle rich</i>	<i>rich</i> : Mod–Head; <i>idle</i> : Mod	Same fusion and modifier functions

Fusion groups *the lucky few* with *the idle rich*; ordinary headedness groups it with *the lucky survivors* and unifies bare and externally determined *few*. Both cover the example. The choice is between sharing fusion across D and adjective, and sharing ordinary Head structure across determinative constructions.

Reducing fusion's applications can simplify this description even when fusion remains available for adjectives. The advantage is the uniform treatment of *few*; its value depends on any additional conditions or lost generalizations elsewhere.¹¹ Section 5.4 compares those costs while holding the lexical restrictions fixed.

The constructed *the remaining three* extends the modifier pattern to cardinals. It doesn't independently decide whether *three* is determinative or has a common-noun use: Reynolds (2026) argues for both uses of cardinals. Section 5.4 treats their unification as a consequence conditional on that analysis.

The modifier permissions needed under ordinary headedness now require a closer comparison.

4.4 MODIFIER SELECTION AND ATTACHMENT

The selection and ordering contrast in §2.3 guides the attachment analysis. Approximative and focusing modifiers have established NP parallels; the degree series selects the four gradable quantifiers. Both ordinary-Head accounts can represent that difference by distinguishing NP-peripheral modification from modification inside Nom.

Peripheral modifiers attach outside an NP's internal dependents. Compare *only you*, *for almost my entire life*, and *Usually a careful driver*, *Anne found her mind wandering*. The modifiers precede any determiner belonging to the NP they modify. CGEL already assigns them NP-level attachment (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 430–431). Focusing *even* and *just*, and approximatives such as *nearly*, *hardly*, *virtually*, and *practically*, likewise have NP uses, subject to their own scope and selectional restrictions.

In *almost every experienced teacher*, *almost* belongs with *every*, while *experienced* modifies *teacher*. Figure 5 places *almost* at the periphery of the NP headed by *every*. That smaller NP functions as Det in the larger NP, whose ultimate head is *teacher*.

¹¹ Compare the theory of second best in Lipsey and Lancaster (1956, pp. 11–12): under a constraint preventing an optimum, satisfying more optimality conditions needn't improve the outcome. The analogy concerns interactions among grammatical choices, not a formal optimum for the grammar.

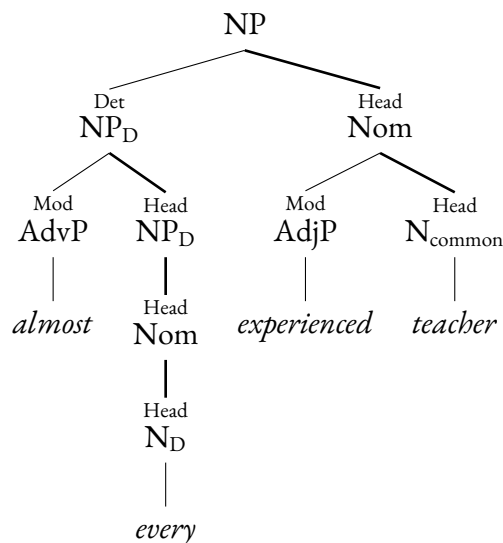


Figure 5: Peripheral *almost* modifies the smaller NP headed by *every*; the resulting *almost every* NP functions as Det. The adjective *experienced* modifies the common-noun nominal. Internal structure within the one-word modifier phrases is suppressed.

Payne et al. (2010, pp. 40–42) defend keeping *few*, *any*, and related forms in one lexical category across dependent and independent uses. In *hardly any money* and independent *hardly any*, *hardly* remains an adverb and *any* retains its category. The D-noun analysis preserves that continuity. It also preserves their contrast between adverbial premodification, as in *almost anybody*, and adjectival postmodification, as in *nothing absolute*.

The proposed analysis gives *very* internal attachment in dependent and independent uses alike. In *the very few people*, it modifies the Nom headed by *few*; the resulting *very few* NP functions as Mod in the larger NP. In *the very few who objected*, *few* remains ordinary Head and *very* remains internal. The degree relation is unchanged, and one internal permission covers both constructions. The same analysis applies to *the very many*.

NP degree modifiers provide a further connection. Determinatives permit determinative premodifiers such as *this* in *this much* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 393). Comparative determinatives also take established NP modifiers: *a lot* in *a lot fewer*, alongside CGEL’s *a lot more than fifty* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 432). These modify the quantity expressed by the head. Under the proposed analysis, they’re internal NP modifiers within its nominal projection, with permissions specific to the head and construction.

Payne et al. (2010, pp. 42–47) establish that adverbs can postmodify common nouns, as in the constructed *the changes globally to the climate*. They also analyse *almost* as modifying the attributive nominal *textbook* in *an almost textbook case* (Payne et al., 2010, p. 75, n. 3). Adverbial modification therefore isn’t categorically excluded from Noun, even internally. Its broader availability with determinatives remains a difference of distribution within the proposed category.

Approximatives need internal attachment where they follow an external determiner on an independent cardinal: *the almost thirty who came*. The internal AdvP permissions at issue are thus the

degree series on *few*, *many*, *much*, and *little* across dependent and independent uses, and approximations on externally determined independent cardinals.

4.5 COMPOUNDS AND THEIR MODIFIER DOMAINS

A more demanding modifier comparison is *hardly anyone present*. Payne et al. (2007, pp. 581–583) assign *hardly* to DP structure and *present* to nominal structure. The compound *anyone* takes the premodifiers of its determinative base *any*: compare *hardly any writer present*. The adjective realizes a specialized RESTRICTOR function, restricted to post-head position and non-recursive. Figure 6 contrasts this account with an ordinary-Head analysis.

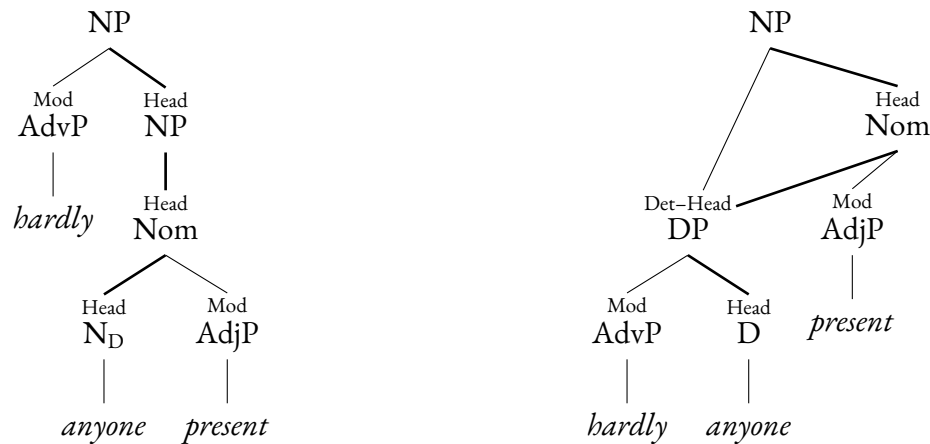


Figure 6: *Hardly anyone present* with ordinary Head (left) and fusion (right). On the left, *hardly* is peripheral to NP and *present* is internal to Nom. Both post-head Mod positions realize the specialized restrictor. In the fusion tree, DP fills Det of NP and Head of Nom, following Payne et al. (2007, p. 582, (13d)). Modifier-phrase interiors are suppressed.

In the ordinary-Head tree, *anyone* inherits nominal projection from Noun and its premodifier permissions from its determinative base. Peripheral *hardly* follows the approximative pattern and its NP parallels in §4.4. The compound construction independently excludes external determination and supplies the internal post-head restrictor permission, with the same position and non-recursion conditions as the fusion account. It doesn't license a corresponding pre-head adjective.

The relative clauses in §2.1 are ordinary postmodifiers, distinct from the specialized restrictor. When both occur, the relative follows it: *something useful that I found*. CGEL explicitly gives compounds the common noun's range of ordinary postmodifiers while preserving this ordering condition (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 423).

The same division applies to *someone* and *everybody*: the compound construction licenses the post-head restrictor, while the determinative base supplies its premodifier permissions. The attested *something reliable and good looking* illustrates the post-head pattern (§2.1).

Both accounts separate the modifier domains structurally: fusion uses the DP–Nom boundary, and ordinary headedness uses the NP–Nom boundary. Their constituent groupings differ: ordinary Head groups *anyone present* in the inner NP, whereas fusion groups *hardly anyone* in DP.

4.6 INDEPENDENT GENITIVES

CGEL also uses fusion with nouns. Anaphoric *mine*, understood as ‘my car’, combines the possessive relation with an understood nominal description and receives a fused analysis. Predicative *mine*, as in *it’s mine*, can instead mean ‘belongs to me’: it expresses the relation directly, without an understood nominal head (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 410–411, 470–471). A suitable context may permit either reading.

The proposed analysis gives *mine* ordinary Head in both anaphoric and predicative uses. Its genitive form expresses a relation to the speaker; context can supply the understood nominal description, as it can with independent *few*. The *my/mine* alternation remains a form-selection condition, parallel to *no/none*. This extends ordinary headedness to an existing noun subcategory.

In referential uses, the independent-genitive construction supplies the NP’s interpretation and agreement properties based on the possessed entity or entities. Compare constructed *I am ready* with *Mine is ready* (‘my contribution’) and *Mine are ready* (‘my slides’). The pronoun’s first-person feature identifies the possessor; the independent NP has third-person singular or plural agreement.

The fragment now makes the permissions and restrictions explicit so that the structural accounts can be compared.

5 THE MATCHED FRAGMENT AND COMPARATIVE COSTS

A grammatical FRAGMENT states rules for a specified range of constructions. The three accounts receive the same judgments and lexical restrictions. Comparing the rules needed for coverage makes their commitments explicit; it doesn’t test them against new data.

5.1 SCOPE AND USE PERMISSIONS

The fragment covers determination, ordinary subject and object uses, partitives, and the modifier and compound comparisons in §4. It admits relative clauses as postmodifiers but doesn’t analyse their internal grammar. Predication, interrogative clause structure, and modification outside NP structure lie beyond its scope. Degree uses enter the wider accounting in §5.3.

Table 4 records USE PERMISSIONS. DEPENDENT means that the form heads a phrase in Det function before another nominal. INDEPENDENT means that its phrase occurs without another nominal in the displayed subject or object uses, as in *Some left* and *I saw some*. These labels describe the constructions covered here, rather than every possible function. Quotation, metalinguistic naming, and subordinate-clause uses of dependent genitives fall outside the fragment. Noun membership doesn’t itself grant a use permission.

Table 4: Shared permissions in the fragment. For *some*, the target column concerns its unstressed use before a noun. The inventory is deliberately limited to the displayed constructions.

Form	Dependent	Independent	Target in the Det construction
<i>the</i>	yes	no	Singular or plural; count or non-count
<i>a, every</i>	yes	no	Singular count nominal
<i>some</i>	yes	yes	Plural count or non-count nominal
<i>few</i>	yes	yes	Plural count nominal
<i>my</i>	yes	no	No count or number restriction
<i>she</i>	no	yes	Not applicable

Further constructional restrictions apply: *she* is a subject form, whereas the corresponding ordinary object form is *her*. The target restrictions concern the common-noun nominal being determined: *a* requires a singular count target such as *book* in *a book*.

Hudson distinguishes dependency from external headedness. He argues that determiner and common noun depend on each other, although only one connects the phrase to its surroundings (Hudson, 2004, pp. 7–8). His temporal adjunct evidence supports common-noun headedness: *I saw him that day* is possible, whereas **I saw him that point in time* isn't, despite the similar temporal meanings (Hudson, 2004, pp. 10–12). The lexical noun matters, as well as the construction's determiner restrictions.

The reciprocal selection facts are substantial: a singular count noun normally requires determination, while *every* requires an overt nominal and *some* doesn't. They establish conditions in both directions. The noun can remain Head while both constituents impose these conditions.

5.2 SHARED PHRASE TYPES AND PROJECTION RULES

In *some apples* and *Kim's apples*, the determining phrases share the NP category under both ordinary-Head accounts: D-noun and separate D. *CGEL* instead distinguishes DP from genitive NP. It also admits a restricted range of plain-case NPs and PPs as determiners, as in *what size hat* and *over thirty ties* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, Ch. 5, §4). The phrase types are:

CGEL: Det : {DP, NP, PP}

Both ordinary-Head accounts: Det : {NP, PP}

Determinative phrases and genitive NPs supply the principal realizations in the separate-D analysis; PPs are restricted. Under ordinary headedness, NP covers both principal types. This consolidation leaves the selectional conditions in place: determinative-headed, genitive, and other licensed NPs still require separate identification. *CGEL* already states definiteness and the single-Det restriction functionally, so recategorization doesn't derive them. The following fragment compares projection once those restrictions are held fixed.

Comparing the ordinary-Head accounts holds projection fixed while varying taxonomy. Comparing the separate-D accounts holds taxonomy fixed while varying headedness. Table 5 summarizes their consequences after the rules have been specified.

The D-noun analysis applies nominal projection to determinatives through their membership in Noun. A separate condition checks use permissions. In the schemata below, *h* identifies the lexical head throughout its projection; parentheses mark optional dependents. The head's entry and construction restrict every dependent. $\text{Mod}_{\text{periph}}$ adds the peripheral premodifier discussed in §4.4; the compact rule leaves further NP layering implicit.

Mod_{post} denotes a possibly empty, constructionally ordered sequence of postmodifiers. For compounds, this permits one specialized restrictor followed by ordinary postmodifiers: *useful* precedes *that I found* in *something useful that I found*. It doesn't permit unrestricted repetition of the restrictor. The same sequence notation and ordering conditions apply under all three accounts.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Nom}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \text{ Head : } N_h \text{ (Comp) } \text{Mod}_{\text{post}} \\ \text{NP}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{periph}}) \text{ (Det) Head : } \text{Nom}_h \\ \text{licensed}(\text{NP}_h, f, c) &\iff f \in U_h \wedge C_h(f, c) \end{aligned}$$

Here U_h is the head's set of use permissions, f is the completed NP's external function, and C_h checks the lexical and constructional conditions in context c . For Det use, these include compatibility with the target nominal; for a singular count argument, they include required determination. Optionality in the second rule doesn't override those conditions. Intermediate Head links within a projection don't require independent argument permission.

These checks accommodate the reciprocal selection discussed by Hudson. The determining phrase checks the target nominal's count and number properties; the outer noun's projection checks whether determination is required and supplied. Both conditions have to hold even though the tree assigns only one Head to each phrase.

In *some apples*, *some* heads an NP whose Det permission and plural-count target requirement are satisfied. *Apples* heads the outer Nom, which heads the NP. In *Some left*, *some* heads an NP whose argument permission is satisfied. *Every apple* passes the Det and singular-count checks; ordinary independent **Every arrived* fails the argument-permission check. *The apple* and **The arrived* differ in the same way.

Each NP's use permissions follow its own head. In *the apple*, the article's Det permission licenses the dependent NP headed by *the*. The outer NP takes its argument permission from *apple*, whose requirement for determination is satisfied by the article.

The same distinction between phrase levels matters beyond the fragment. In *I know which apple it is*, *which* heads the determining phrase inside *which apple*. The whole *which apple* is the preposed predicative complement of *is* in the embedded interrogative clause. Its function doesn't make *which* independent; *apple* still heads that NP.

A singular count common noun such as *book* faces a different restriction from an article. In *a book*, its requirement for determination is satisfied; bare **Book arrived* leaves that requirement unsatisfied. *Books arrived* has no such requirement. Requiring determination for a common noun doesn't itself block an article-headed NP from argument use. An article's exclusion from argument use must still be stated separately.

Some and *few* permit a partitive *of*-phrase within their nominal projection. Peripheral *almost* modifies the NP headed by *every*; this doesn't license *experienced* as its modifier. Degree *very* modifies *few* internally across dependent and independent uses. Externally determined *few* also permits adjectival *lucky*. The cardinal construction *the almost thirty who came* licenses internal approximative *almost*. In *hardly anyone present*, *hardly* is peripheral to NP and the restrictor *present* is internal to Nom.

Under separate D with ordinary Head, the NP and use-permission rules are the same. Its Nom rule admits either Noun or determinative as lexical head:

$$\text{Nom}_h \rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \quad \text{Head} : \{N_h, D_h\} \quad (\text{Comp}) \quad \text{Mods}_{\text{post}}$$

This projection applies to dependent as well as independent determinatives, eliminating DP from the fragment while retaining primary D. Determiner selection still identifies D-headed NPs and suitable genitives. In *the lucky few*, *few* is D in ordinary Head function. In *hardly anyone present*, the determinative base and compound construction supply the same modifier restrictions as the D-noun account. Adjectival Mod-Head fusion remains available in both.

The separate-D fusion account relates independent determinatives to their dependent counterparts. In addition to nominal projection for nouns, it uses DP projection and permits a DP to realize

a fused function in nominal structure. The partitive complement and compound restrictor belong to Nom, following the trees in *CGEL* and Payne et al. (2007, p. 582):

$$\begin{aligned} DP_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) \text{ Head} : D_h \text{ (Comp)} \\ \text{Nom}_h &\rightarrow (\text{Mod}_{\text{pre}}) F : DP_h \text{ (Comp)} \text{ Mods}_{\text{post}} \\ F &\in \{\text{Det-Head}, \text{Mod-Head}\} \end{aligned}$$

The ordinary NP rule embeds this Nom. Det-Head jointly realizes Det of NP and Head of Nom, excluding a second Det; Mod-Head fills an internal modifier's function and Head of Nom, allowing external determination. Lexical and constructional conditions select the fused function and permitted dependents. These schemata cover independent *few*, *few of them*, *the lucky few*, and *hardly anyone present*.

Dependent determinatives gain a Nom layer under either ordinary-Head account. Both rules admit the same heads, through inheritance or the disjunction {N, D}. Putting the grouping in the lexical hierarchy produces HARMONY between taxonomy and phrase structure, but earns no additional credit for rules both accounts share.

A grammar with Hudson's nested categorization can use the same permissions and projection rules. Holding those rules fixed, placing the broader pronoun category on determinative's inheritance path from Noun leaves the fragment's judgments unchanged.

5.3 DEGREE USES OUTSIDE NOUN PHRASES

The fragment's NP constructions leave a further cost to be assessed. Determinatives also modify expressions outside NP structure. Giving these uses NP projection affects which kinds of phrase the grammar admits as degree modifiers.

Enough tests both position and external function. It precedes a nominal in *enough money* and can follow one in *money enough*; post-head *enough* can't itself be premodified, as shown by **money almost enough* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 396–397, 445). Only the permitted construction licenses each position.

Enough also modifies adjectives, adverbs, verbs, and some PPs: *good enough*, *quickly enough*, *I hadn't prepared enough*, and *enough in control* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 396–397). The degree determinatives *much* and *little*, and *no/none*, likewise have uses outside NP structure (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 390, 395–397). These permissions must survive recategorization. Noun membership doesn't confine every projection to argument or determiner function.¹²

NPs already modify adjectives in *three years old*, *a great deal smaller*, and *plenty big enough* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 549–550). These include the quantificational common nouns compared in §2.2. Degree modification therefore supplies another connection with existing nouns, but also another restriction: *CGEL* contrasts predicative *a great deal better* with its exclusion before a noun in **some a great deal better proposals*, where *much better* is permitted (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 551–552).

This restriction already has an exception involving a quantificational common noun. *CGEL* permits *She's a lot better player than me*, analysing the article belonging to *a lot* as lost after the article

¹² *Both*, *either*, and *neither* also serve as markers of coordination (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 1305, 1308). Their noun categorization would preserve that further category–function combination; the present fragment doesn't analyse coordination.

determining the larger NP (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, p. 552, n. 8). The general restriction on NP modifiers in attributive AdjPs is therefore qualified in the baseline grammar.

Extending determinative NP projection to degree uses admits a broader range in those positions. Both ordinary-Head accounts then need to identify the permitted determinative-headed NPs while retaining exclusions such as **some a great deal better proposals*. This cost favours keeping DP against both NP-projecting alternatives; it doesn't independently favour primary D over a determinative subcategory of Noun.

5.4 THE COMPARATIVE JUDGMENT

Table 5 separates shared structure, internal permissions, existing restrictions, the additional degree-use cost, and taxonomic consequences. The last row groups consequences of the same recategorization rather than counting them as separate gains. The comparison holds the inventory, constructions, and readings fixed.

Table 5: Comparative accounting. These are descriptive commitments, not numerical scores. Extending the accounts to degree uses incurs the same NP-modifier cost under both ordinary-Head taxonomies; that cost favours retaining DP, without deciding the primary-category boundary.

Criterion	D-noun, ordinary Head	Separate D, ordinary Head	Separate D, fusion
Shared structure	Nom–NP and ordinary Head across bare, partitive, and externally determined uses. Adjectival fusion retained.	Same projection and Head relations as D-noun. Adjectival fusion retained.	DP plus nominal structure; Det–Head or Mod–Head for independent determinatives. Fusion shared with adjectives.
Internal permissions	Internal degree AdvP on <i>few</i> , <i>many</i> , <i>much</i> , <i>little</i> ; approximatives after Det with independent cardinals.	Same internal permissions, stated for primary D; same peripheral NP modification.	DP and Nom separate the premodifier and nominal postmodifier domains.
Existing restrictions	Article-use permissions, <i>no/none</i> selection, and compound restrictor order and non-recursion retained.	Same lexical and constructional restrictions retained.	Same lexical and constructional restrictions retained.
Additional degree-use cost	NP degree modifiers require a broader permission in attributive AdjPs, preserving the remaining exclusions.	Same extension when NP projection includes degree uses.	DP–NP distinction retains the degree contrast, including exceptional NP constructions.
Taxonomic consequences	One fewer primary category. Cardinal uses and the three lexemes spelled <i>one</i> fall within Noun; internal distinctions remain.	D remains separate. Determinative cardinals and determinative <i>one</i> remain primarily separate from nominal counterparts.	Same primary-category divisions as separate D with ordinary Head.

The articles’ restrictions, *no/none* form selection, and the compound restrictor conditions are already required in the separate-D grammar. Retaining them isn’t an added cost of D-noun. Likewise, differences among existing noun subcategories in determination and modification remain in place (Table 2).

The ordinary-Head accounts tie on shared structure. Both use peripheral NP modification and the same internal modifier permissions (§4.4); both incur the further degree-use cost (§5.3). D-noun expresses the shared projection through inheritance, while separate D states a rule applying to both primary categories. The preference between them depends on the profile comparison in §2.

Reynolds (2026) distinguishes determinative numerals such as *ten* in *ten men*, proper-noun cases such as *10* in *Room 10*, and common-noun numerals such as *tens* in *tens of pens*. Under the D-noun analysis, all fall within primary Noun, retaining their subcategory and constructional differences. Ordinals remain adjectives, and complex numeral phrases remain distinct from single lexemes.

Payne et al. (2013, pp. 797–798) distinguish three lexemes spelled *one*: determinative, anaphoric common noun, and generic pronoun. These remain distinct under the D-noun analysis, but all belong within primary Noun.

Complex cardinals also separate category from function. In *two hundred books*, the whole *two hundred* fills Det; internally, *two* modifies the magnitude head *hundred* (Reynolds, 2026, §4). In *these two hundred books*, *these* fills Det and *two hundred* is an internal modifier. One Det function doesn't entail a limit of one determinative lexeme per NP.

These cardinals and the lexemes spelled *one* retain their distinctions within one primary category. Their grouping follows from the proposed hierarchy, whose support comes from the broader profile comparison.

I favour the broader Noun category because the profile comparison supports placing the shared nominal structure at that level. Determinative restrictions remain within it. Separate D crosses a primary boundary in its projection rule; that is a coherent alternative. Reducing the number of primary categories alone wouldn't establish the preference.

If determinative-headed and genitive expressions require different projection rules after their independently motivated restrictions are held fixed, the shared-projection proposal in §5.2 loses its advantage. That would favour separate phrase types. Retaining a separate primary D requires the further case that the category boundary captures the recurring differences better than a determinative subcategory within Noun.

6 COORDINATE OR NESTED SUBCATEGORIES

Including determinatives within Noun leaves a further question: where within Noun do they belong? In the proposed hierarchy, common noun, proper noun, pronoun, and determinative are four coordinate subcategories. Hudson instead puts determinative inside pronoun, which is itself inside Noun. Both group determinatives with nouns. They differ in whether pronouns and determinatives form an intermediate category that excludes common and proper nouns.

Hudson makes taxonomic inclusion explicit. His noun category contains common noun, proper noun, and pronoun (Hudson, 2010, pp. 253–254); a determiner is a pronoun whose VALENCY permits the relevant common-noun dependent (Hudson, 2004, pp. 9–10). The word's category remains constant across independent and dependent uses, which differ in their permitted dependents.

Hudson's criteria centre on licensing a singular count common noun and on mutual exclusion in that use. He sets aside *all*, cardinal numerals, and quantifiers restricted to plural or non-count nouns (Hudson, 2004, pp. 9–10). Their place in his taxonomy remains unsettled by those criteria. Extending the pronoun analysis to CGEL's fuller inventory requires comparing its modifier selection, grade, and quantitative meanings with the existing pronouns' properties.

The intermediate category would be useful if it supported grammatical generalizations applying to pronouns and determinatives together. The coordinate analysis can still record properties shared by those two groups; it doesn't claim that every noun subcategory is equally similar to every other. The issue is whether their shared properties warrant another level in the lexical hierarchy.

Reynolds (2021) compares 138 word forms through properties recorded as present or absent, such as accepting *almost*. Its unsupervised clustering groups forms by these similarities without being given their category labels. The groups broadly resemble the pronoun and determinative inventories, though the outcome varies with initialization and feature selection.¹³ But the study contains no common or proper nouns. Distinguishing the two groups therefore establishes neither their taxonomic rank nor the proposed superordinate category.

The grammatical case for nesting needs to be assessed on its own. Many pronouns and determinatives have little descriptive content and depend on context for interpretation. Pro-form gender supplies further connections (§2.4). These properties make the grouping plausible, but they don't uniquely identify it: primary naming uses of proper nouns also depend on context, and pro-form gender extends to non-nominal expressions (Reynolds, 2025).

Restrictions on determination and modification are another candidate. Personal pronouns generally resist external determiners and permit few internal modifiers: *poor old me* illustrates the restricted adjectival pattern (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 429–430). But proper names also resist free determination and modification in their primary uses (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 517, 519–520). These restrictions don't pick out pronouns and determinatives alone.

Nor are those restrictions uniform within the proposed intermediate category. Determinatives allow *the few*, *the two*, and *these three*, with item-specific conditions; *CGEL* gives *these few here* and *the many who did* (Huddleston & Pullum, 2002, pp. 415–416). Their adverbial modifier patterns differ from the restricted adjectival pattern of personal pronouns. A broader pronoun category couldn't simply pass the personal pronouns' rules down to determinatives.

I therefore place determinative alongside pronoun. Their shared nominal structure belongs at the Noun level, while their more specific patterns remain distinct: person, case, and reflexivity organize much of the pronoun system; quantification, determination, and degree organize much of the determinative system. Nesting remains a coherent alternative, but the comparisons here don't establish a further shared set of grammatical rules that requires it.

Both inheritance paths supply the fragment's structures (§5.2). The coordinate preference rests on the more specific profile; accepting Noun membership and ordinary Head leaves this further choice open.

7 CONCLUSION

I propose including English determinatives within Noun. The strongest positive comparison comes from quantificational common nouns: their selected complements, number transparency, restricted dependents, and degree uses connect with parts of the determinative inventory. The connected adjectival profile of the four gradable quantifiers deserves weight on the same terms. Broader constructional and referential connections, with partial inflectional corroboration, favour the nominal grouping.

The grouping includes restricted members through their integration into the determinative system. Articles needn't independently exhibit the whole profile, and *no/none* retains its form-selection

¹³The study reports 232 properties, whereas the public file contains 155. The accompanying [Replication audit of the English determinative-pronoun feature matrix](#) documents the discrepancy, reproduces the published statistical decomposition, and examines sensitivity. The public file is preserved unchanged.

conditions. The argument for membership thus concerns a category with internal differences, rather than unrestricted use by every form.

Ordinary Head provides a uniform structure for bare, partitive, and externally determined determinatives. Both D-noun and separate D can license it, and both incur the additional degree-modifier cost. I prefer the broader taxonomy because the profile supports placing the shared structure within Noun. Coordinate rank alongside pronoun is a further preference: the present comparisons don't establish the additional shared rules that nesting would express.

A EARLIER ACCOUNTS AND LOGICAL ALTERNATIVES

Keeping a word in one category across dependent and independent uses leaves its taxonomic position open. As J. Lyons (1968, pp. 232–235) observes, distribution can be compared at different levels: two expressions may belong together at one level and differ at a more specific level. Table 6 distinguishes the selected authors' proposals, their analytical levels, and further logical alternatives.

Table 6: Selected accounts and logical alternatives. The earlier proposals differ in scope and representational level; they don't all specify a surface taxonomy. The prose gives sources and inventory qualifications.

Account	Proposed relationship	Level or status
Palmer	Determinative adjectives grouped with pronouns.	Lexical grouping; inclusive Noun unspecified
Postal	Personal pronouns analysed as articles, with deeper noun features.	Intermediate and underlying representations
Sommerstein	Definite article and personal pronouns given NP structure.	Underlying representation
Lyons	Articles, demonstratives, and personal pronouns linked by definiteness and deixis.	Semantic relationship
<i>CGEL</i>	Pronoun within Noun; determinative separate.	Lexical taxonomy
Hudson	Determiners within pronoun, which is within noun.	Lexical taxonomy
Spinillo	Determinatives redistributed; <i>the</i> , <i>a</i> , and <i>every</i> retained as articles.	Lexical recategorization
D-noun analysis	Common noun, proper noun, pronoun, and determinative coordinate within Noun.	Proposed taxonomy
Logical alternative	Noun, pronoun, and determinative separate.	For comparison
Logical alternative	Determinative within Noun; pronoun separate.	For comparison
Logical alternative	Pronoun within determinative, which is within Noun.	For comparison
Logical alternative	Pronoun within proper noun; determinative within common noun.	For comparison

Palmer (1924, p. 24) proposed placing “determinative adjectives” with pronouns. He contrasted them with qualifying adjectives, which permit predicative use, comparison, and adverbial modification. Most determinatives, he observed, can “be used indifferently as pronouns or as modifiers of nouns”. J. Lyons (1968, p. 279) adds a semantic connection: articles, demonstratives, and personal pronouns share definiteness and deictic contrasts.

Postal (1966) develops the article–pronoun connection through English reflexives and combinations such as *we men*. His category assignments depend on representational level: article segments occur at intermediate stages, their deepest counterparts are features of nouns, and surface pronouns can receive derivative Noun status. This differs from a proposal about the lexical taxonomy of the surface words.

Sommerstein (1972, pp. 197–203) argues in the opposite direction, giving the definite article and personal pronouns underlying NP structure. His English comparison includes the count restriction on anaphoric *one*, whereas *it* can refer to a quantity of a substance.¹⁴

These predecessors challenge a fundamental article–pronoun separation but leave the full determinative inventory uncategorized. Its contrasts in grade, modification, complementation, and restricted independent use extend beyond their proposals. Hudson’s explicit nesting and Spinillo’s redistribution are assessed in §§6 and 3, respectively.

DATA AND ANALYSIS MATERIALS

The accompanying supplements are *Replication audit of the English determinative–pronoun feature matrix* and *CGELBank concordance and extraction notes*. The analysis/ directory preserves their input files, provenance records, scripts, numerical outputs, and sentence concordance. Its README identifies the files and reproduction procedures.

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¹⁴Payne et al. (2013, pp. 797–798) analyse anaphoric *one* as a common count noun, distinct from determinative *one* and personal pronoun *one*.

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